

Flour Frontier Project Portfolio

Executive Summary · NAF FSI Flour 10-Year Allocation Study · Jake Gilstein · NAF Sales Intern

HEADLINE

Houston has the biggest accessible flour opportunity in the country (GMI Index 49, a roughly 9-million-pound annual gap). Texas (+5.3% YoY) is an execution issue, not a market issue. Atlanta GFS already +122.5% YoY validates the Southeast recommendation.

The True 5's Ranked

#	Metro	GM Zone	Distributors	Census Region	Mill Distance	Headline
1	Houston	WEST	Labatt-San Antonio, Sysco-Houston	South	702mi to KC	GMI Index 49, biggest market opportunity in the US
2	Dallas-Fort Worth	WEST	Sysco-Central TX, Sysco-North TX	South	462mi to KC	Market healthy (+5.3% YoY), Sysco-TX is execution issue
3	Atlanta	EAST	GFS-Shepherdsville, Sysco-Atlanta	South	798mi to KC	GFS already growing +122.5% YoY, recommendation working
4	Tampa-St. Pete	EAST	Cheney Brothers, Sysco-W. Coast FL	South	1,001mi to BF	Fastest True 5 growth (+13.9% GMI YoY)
5	Phoenix	WEST	Shamrock Foods, Sysco-Arizona	West	370mi to VN	Only positive YoY in losing region, defense play

Circana Market Context (TTM May '25 – April '26)

Region	Market Size	GMI Share	GMI YoY	Notes
Northeast	347M lbs	56.4%	+1.2%	Mature, high-share, defensive posture
Central	244M lbs	22.7%	+5.5%	Gaining share off a low base
South	794M lbs	28.6%	+5.1%	Largest market and biggest open runway
West	380M lbs	35.4%	-2.5%	Losing 1.1pp share, defend Vernon and Phoenix

Recommendations (ordered by urgency)

1.) Stabilize Texas (FY27 Q1)

Sysco-Central TX (-38%) and Sysco-North TX (36%) are the top 5 customer losses in the entire NAF book, and they sit in our second-ranked metro. The DFW market itself is growing +5.3% YoY, so there are execution gaps not market shifts. Launch a 3-week root cause sprint with Melissa Magsalin to categorize the loss (competitive, distributor consolidation, or program execution) and define remediation by end of FY27 Q1.

2.) Win the Southeast corridor over the next 12 months

Atlanta, Tampa, Charlotte, and Nashville cluster in the strongest region per Circana and contain our biggest cold spot. Three concurrent actions: (a) deepen the GFS-Shepherdsville partnership where GMI is already up +122.5% YoY, (b) commission a toll mill feasibility study for the Florida market versus the current 1,001-mile Buffalo to Orlando rail lane, (c) replicate Josh Cohen's Nashville playbook into Jeffrey Santiago's FL territory.

3.) Build the Houston opportunity case in the next 12 to 18 months

Houston is a 60.3M lb DMA where GM holds GMI Index 49, less than half national parity. Reaching parity unlocks roughly 9 million pounds annually from a single metro. Action: scope a Houston-specific go-to-market plan with Gus Patrick focused on independent restaurant density and petrochemical workforce concentration.

4.) Defend the West

Circana shows West GMI losing 1.1 percentage points of share and down 2.5% in volume. Phoenix is the only True 5 metro with positive YoY performance and the cleanest transport story (370 miles direct truck from Vernon). Double down on the Shamrock Foods relationship and prevent further share erosion before evaluating any Vernon-area capacity decisions.

Sources: Circana Supply Track Monthly Pro · GMI Region Full and Account Full data · Flour and BB Mix Dashboard · CF Invoice Volume · February 2026 Flour by DMA